



BRAND BLUEPRINT / V1.3

Spare Hours

Small things worth building.

An independent software studio that uses spare time to build useful, interesting things that deserve to exist.

USEFUL
FOCUSED
HONEST

A small studio with a strong filter

"Someone noticed a useful little thing that ought to exist, then quietly built it well."

BRAND STATEMENT

Spare Hours is an independent software studio that uses spare time to build small, useful, interesting things that deserve to exist.

INTERNAL ESSENCE

Worth the time.

Worth our limited time to build. Worth the user's time to install, learn and keep.

01

Low-complexity, high-value

Do fewer things. Make the chosen things genuinely useful.

02

Worth building

Every product needs a reason to exist beyond "we could build it."

03

Honest

No inflated claims, artificial urgency or complexity disguised as ambition.

PRODUCT PROMISE

Thoughtful software without unnecessary machinery.

Small by choice, not by apology

WHO IT IS FOR

Android and Wear OS users who value focus, fast comprehension and products that respect battery, privacy and attention.

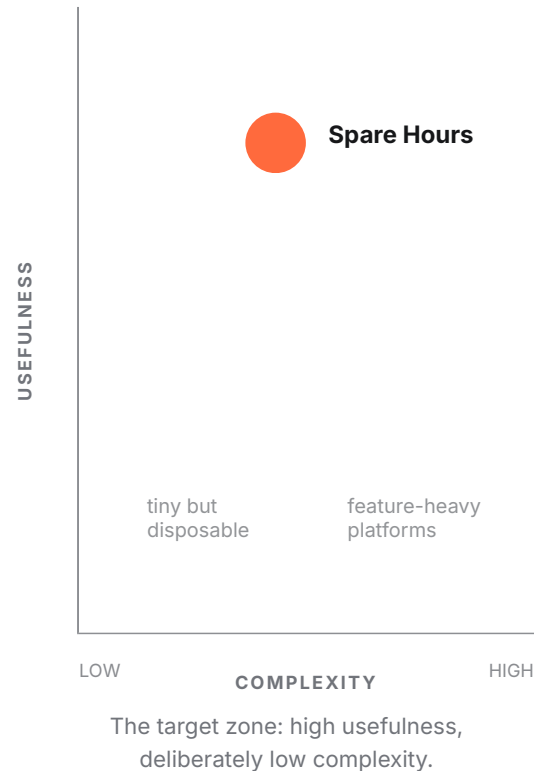
THE TENSION

Many small apps behave like startups: more accounts, more dashboards, more subscriptions, more permissions, more features. Spare Hours takes the opposite position. Complexity must earn its place.

PERSONALITY

The Craftsperson + a little Explorer

Capable, curious, restrained and slightly obsessive about details. Interested in making, not performing innovation.



FOCUSED

One clear job is more credible than a pile of adjacent features.

RESPECTFUL

Battery, privacy, permissions and attention are product constraints, not afterthoughts.

INDEPENDENT

Products can be narrow, unusual or delightful without needing a venture-scale story.

Quiet foundation. One energetic detail.

The palette feels like a small digital workshop: neutral and calm, with Build Orange marking the moment something becomes active, finished or worth noticing.

Workshop Ink

#161719

Primary dark. Focus and depth without pure-black harshness.

Warm Paper

#F4F1E8

Primary light. Human and tactile rather than clinical white.

Build Orange

#FF6A3D

Signature accent. Energy, making and the final useful detail.

Tool Steel

#71747A

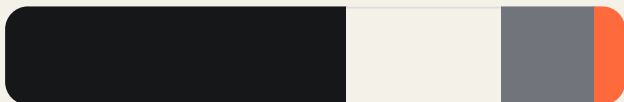
metadata / secondary

Electric Blue

#3978F6

links / product interaction

PROPORTION



Roughly 80% neutrals, 15% supporting tone, 5% orange. The accent gains meaning by staying scarce.

ACCESSIBILITY

Use Ink for body text. Build Orange works strongly on Ink, but should not carry small body copy on Warm Paper. Electric Blue is a utility accent, not a second brand colour.

Wear OS: true black can replace Workshop Ink in OLED and ambient contexts. Battery efficiency outranks perfect marketing consistency on the watch.

Designed enough to be distinctive. Familiar enough to disappear.

HEADINGS

Space Grotesk

Geometric and slightly mechanical, but not cold. It gives the studio a crafted edge without becoming techno.

MEDIUM / SEMIBOLD

BODY AND UI

Inter

The workhorse. Highly readable on screens and neutral enough to let the product do the talking.

REGULAR / MEDIUM

SUGGESTED HIERARCHY

Small things worth building.

A useful product should explain itself quickly.

Use comfortable line lengths, sentence case and generous space. The brand should feel composed rather than compressed.

v1.3.0 / approved logo master / updated today

OPTIONAL TECHNICAL ACCENT

IBM Plex Mono

Use sparingly for versions, build notes and technical annotations.

ANDROID AND WEAR OS

Native readability wins

Do not force brand fonts where system typography renders better. Brand consistency must not reduce glanceability.

Show the making, not the machinery

The recurring story is simple: notice something small, make it carefully, turn it into something useful.



PRODUCT IMAGERY

Real screens first

Use actual watch faces, app screens and close product details. Let usefulness be the hero.

PHOTOGRAPHY

Normal life

Real desks, wrists, coffee and evening light. Avoid staged startup teams and glossy future-tech scenes.

MOTION

Quiet completion

Short reveals or pieces settling into place. No decorative perpetual motion, especially on Wear OS.

GRAPHIC MOTIF

Use the seed, sprout curve and orange leaf as the visual vocabulary. Avoid unrelated geometric blocks that need explanation.

LAYOUT

One idea at a time. Strong hierarchy, generous negative space and consistent corner radii. Do not fill every surface because space exists.

Capable person. Plain language. Zero theatre.

RULE 01

Say what it does first.

Function before cleverness.
The user should not decode the benefit.

RULE 02

Prefer precise, ordinary words.

"Uses less battery" beats
"optimised efficiency architecture."

RULE 03

Personality without hype.

Dry, curious and occasionally playful. Never desperate for attention.

SAY THIS, NOT THAT

Instead of

~~Revolutionise your productivity.~~

See your next event at a glance.

~~A seamless, next-generation wearable experience.~~

Time, next event and not much else.

~~Unlock the full power of your day.~~

**No account. No feed.
Just the thing you need.**

WORDS WE USE

small

useful

built

thoughtful

focused

quiet

practical

independent

worth

detail

BUZZWORDS WE AVOID

revolutionary

disruptive

ecosystem

game-changing

supercharge

unlock

leverage

cutting-edge

AI-powered*

*Unless AI is genuinely central to the product.

A VERY SPARE HOURS PRODUCT DESCRIPTION

"A tiny Wear OS watch face for people who want the time, their next event and not much else."

A small idea becoming real



MEANING

Seed → effort → something alive

The seed is the small idea. The stem is the act of making. The orange leaf is the moment the idea becomes tangible.

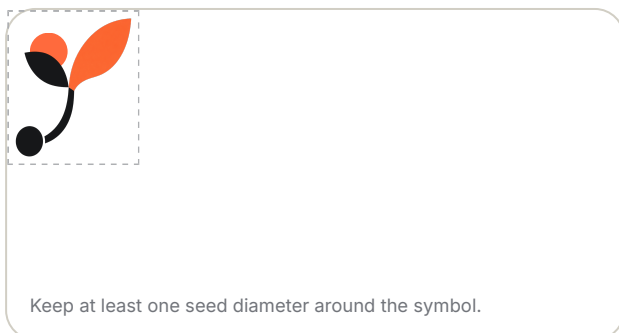
GEOMETRY RULE

Use the approved master artwork exactly. The silhouette, proportions, colour treatment and spacing are fixed. Approved colour variants may change only the cream elements for contrast; never redraw, auto-trace, thicken the stem, resize individual leaves or reinterpret the symbol.

PREFERRED FORMS



CLEAR SPACE



USAGE RULES

Symbol alone: avatars, favicons and compact surfaces.

Wordmark: studio identity, website, GitHub and store presence.

Never: attach the tagline to the logo, add shadows to the mark, stretch it, or turn it into a clock.

Brand the studio. Let the product do its job.

Spare Hours should build recognition without making a tiny utility feel like a corporate product suite.

SURFACE	USE	RULE
Play developer profile	Symbol + Spare Hours	Primary studio identity. Keep product names secondary.
App icon	Product identity first	Do not stamp the studio sprout onto every product by default.
Wear OS face	Usually invisible	Utility and glanceability outrank brand exposure on the dial.
Website / GitHub	Full wordmark + tagline	Best place to tell the "small things worth building" story.
Screenshots / launch	Product first, brand sign-off	One logo is enough. Avoid watermarking every frame.

WEAR OS GUARDRAILS

Branding must never cost usefulness.

Prefer OLED black. Keep bright branded areas small. Avoid ambient animation. If branding competes with time, complications, legibility or battery, remove the branding.

FUTURE PRODUCTS

Consistency without sameness.

Products can have their own names, iconography and supporting accent. Reuse principles and components rather than making every app visually identical.

RULE OF RESTRAINT

If brand treatment makes the product less useful, the brand treatment loses.



09 / THE SPARE HOURS FILTER

Before it ships, ask five things.



Can we explain it in one sentence?

If the job is fuzzy, the product probably is too.



Does it create clear value quickly?

Especially on Wear OS, the useful moment should be glanceable.



Can anything be removed?

Every feature, account, permission, service and dependency has a maintenance cost.



Does it respect the user?

Battery, privacy, attention, time and money are part of product quality.



Would we spend our spare hours maintaining it?

If the answer is no, it probably does not deserve to exist under this brand.

Small things worth building.